Michael Owen was really pumped up. He had things under control but I'd seen the fire in his eyes before kick-off. Now we were behind, he was shouting at anybody in earshot:

'Come on. We can win this. We can beat them.'

And we all knew he was right. Five minutes later, Michael got the equalizer—the first goal of his hat-trick—and we never looked back.

We were that sure of ourselves. I think the Germans picked up on it and their nerve started to go. Oliver Kahn, their world-class goalkeeper, had one of his worst-ever nights. It turned into one of those rare games in which everything you could possibly want to happen does. Steven Gerrard's goal, right at the end of the first half, was a great strike. It flew in from twenty-odd yards: his first goal for England. Even better, it went in at the perfect time for us. If a game's tight, taking the lead just before half-time gives the team that scores a real edge psychologically. He'd missed qualifying games through injury but Stevie made up for it that night in Munich. We're so much better balanced with him in the side. He's still young but he's like a Roy Keane or a Patrick Vieira: he tackles and will run all day; he can pass and he'll score goals. He's got the complete midfield game: it's no coincidence that England rarely lose with Steven Gerrard in the eleven.

I don't know about the other lads but I was more nervous at half-time than I had been before the game. I remember going into the dressing room, 2–1 up, and not being sure how we should approach the second 45 minutes. After a first half, Sven always lets everybody come in and settle for five minutes: sit down, unlace your boots, get a drink, whatever it is you need to do. There were conversations going on between players straight away, with everyone buzzing:

'Do we go out and try to defend 2–1? Do we attack and hope to get another goal that'll win it?'

I think we all knew we didn't need to change anything. That's what Sven told us too. There were more goals there for us to score and we could trust our defense to protect our lead. The second half was like playing in a dream. Michael got his second goal just a few minutes after the kick-off. And then his third. And then Scholesy rolled one through for Emile Heskey to score too. I remember when Emile's shot went in, I turned round to look at the bench to see how people were reacting: it was the same as what was going on in the stands and, I'd guess, in front of the television back at home. The subs and the coaching staff were just falling about, hugging each other. You could